figured and eternal life—again I should point to India.'

Nearly half a century later Romain Rolland wrote in the same strain: 'If there is one place on the face of the earth where all the dreams of living men have found a home from the very earliest days when m a n began the dream of existence, it is India.'

T h e U p a n i s h a d s

T h e Upanishads, dating from about 800 B.C., take us a step further in the development of Indo-Aryan thought, and it is a big step. T h e Aryans have long been settled down and a stable, prosperous civilization has grown up, a mixture of the old and the new, dominated by Aryan thought and ideals, but with a background of more primitive forms of worship. 1'he Vedas are referred to with respect, but also in a spirit of gentle irony. T h e Vedic gods no longer satisfy and the ritual of the priests is made fun of. But there is no attempt to break with the past; the past is taken as a starting point for further progress.

T h e Upanishads are instinct with a spirit of inquiry, of mental adventure, of a passion for finding out the truth about things. T h e search for this truth is, of course, not by the objective methods of modern science, yet there is an element of the scientific method